

FREE PREVIEW · SCROLL STOPPERS

Scroll Stoppers

10 hooks that stop the scroll in the first second.

A free preview of the Scroll Stoppers system: the hook, the psychology behind it, when to use it, and a ready-to-paste AI video prompt for each one.

10

HOOKS

1

CATEGORIES

10

AI PROMPTS INCLUDED

How To Use This Guide

Every hook in this guide follows the same four-part structure, so you can scan it fast and put it to work the same day.

These 10 are pulled from the full 100-hook system. They're a genuine sample, not a watered-down teaser, so you can start using them today.

- 1. The Hook — what it is, in plain language.**
- 2. Why It Works — the psychology behind it, so you can adapt it instead of copying it.**
- 3. When & How To Use It — the content types it fits, and the ones it doesn't.**
- 4. AI Prompt — a ready-to-paste prompt for your AI video generator of choice, so you can generate the opening shot instead of filming it.**

A note on the AI prompts: paste them as written into your AI video generator of choice and adjust the subject, setting, and colors to match your footage. The camera direction and lighting language is what actually does the work, keep that part intact.

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10 Free Hooks From Scroll Stoppers

A cross-section of the full 100-hook system: reveal, curiosity, danger, urgency, callout, story, transition, UI, and interactive formats.

Delayed Reveal

Open on an intense reaction shot, hold 2-4 seconds before showing what caused it.

● WHY IT WORKS

The brain treats an unexplained reaction as an open question. It has to know what caused that face, so it keeps watching to close the gap.

● WHEN & HOW TO USE IT

Use when your payoff is genuinely strong: a transformation, a location, a result. If the reveal is average, this hook backfires because you set up a bigger expectation than you can pay off.

● AI PROMPT

"Extreme close-up on a person's shocked face, eyes wide, mouth slightly open, natural window light, handheld camera, 3 second hold, then whip pan to reveal [your subject]. Cinematic, shallow depth of field."

Curiosity Gap Question

Ask a compelling question, hold a beat, then answer it visually instead of verbally.

● WHY IT WORKS

A visual answer lands faster and sticks longer than a spoken explanation. The question opens the gap, the image closes it, and the whole loop feels satisfying rather than lecture-y.

● WHEN & HOW TO USE IT

Use for mission, motivation, or 'why I do this' content. Keep the question under 8 words so it reads instantly.

● AI PROMPT

"Text overlay reads a short question, camera holds on a neutral face for 2 seconds, then hard cut to a strong visual answer, natural lighting, minimal camera movement."

Mess Up Hook

Open on a confident setup that immediately fails.

● WHY IT WORKS

It breaks the expectation of a polished skill video. That broken expectation triggers humor, shock, or empathy fast enough to stop a scrolling thumb within 3 seconds.

● WHEN & HOW TO USE IT

Use for fails, bloopers, and expectation-vs-reality content. The fail has to look real. A staged fail reads as fake instantly and kills trust.

● AI PROMPT

"Subject confidently begins a physical action, camera holds steady, unexpected stumble or fail happens mid-motion, natural reaction shot follows, handheld documentary-style camera, real-feeling lighting."

Danger Hook

Open with a real or implied threat: 'this almost got me banned,' 'this could hurt you.'

● WHY IT WORKS

Threat detection runs on autopilot and overrides most other filtering the brain does while scrolling. It reacts to potential danger before it consciously evaluates relevance.

● WHEN & HOW TO USE IT

Use for platform-policy warnings, safety content, or 'mistakes to avoid' videos. The danger claim needs to be true, exaggerated danger hooks get called out fast.

● AI PROMPT

"Speaker looks slightly off-camera with a concerned expression, dim warm lighting, close framing, subtle handheld camera movement, serious tone conveyed through posture and pacing."

Urgency Hook

Frame the content as something to see before doing an everyday action again: 'before you eat/drink/do X again.'

● WHY IT WORKS

Loss aversion makes people more motivated to avoid a mistake they're about to repeat than to learn a new benefit. Framing it as 'before you do it again' implies an active, ongoing risk.

● WHEN & HOW TO USE IT

Use for habit, health, or money content where there's a real behavior change to recommend. Works especially well tied to daily habits.

● AI PROMPT

"Subject reaches for an everyday object, hand freezes mid-reach as text overlay appears, quick zoom on the object, natural kitchen or home lighting, brief tense pause."

Direct Callout Hook

Speak directly to the viewer as if addressing only them: 'you forgot this again.'

● WHY IT WORKS

This is the cocktail party effect: the brain automatically filters for anything addressed to its own identity, even in a noisy or crowded feed.

● WHEN & HOW TO USE IT

Use for personal development, mindset, or coaching content. The message has to feel personally relevant, generic motivation doesn't trigger the same filter.

● AI PROMPT

"Speaker looks directly into the lens as if speaking to one specific person, close intimate framing, soft warm lighting, minimal background, calm steady delivery."

Open Loop Hook

Open with an unexpected result you're about to reveal: 'I didn't expect what happened when I tested this for 30 days.'

● WHY IT WORKS

This is the Zeigarnik effect: unfinished stories occupy working memory until they're resolved. The brain keeps a mental tab open on unresolved narratives.

● WHEN & HOW TO USE IT

Use for experiments, transformations, and process-reveal content with a genuine result at the end, not a manufactured twist.

● AI PROMPT

"Time-lapse or montage teaser of a process in progress, quick flashes of different days or stages, energetic pacing, consistent lighting style across all clips."

Transition Hook

A hard cut or whip-pan lands between two visually contrasting scenes.

● WHY IT WORKS

Fast, unpredictable visual change is harder for the brain to fully process in real time, which keeps attention locked in rather than letting it drift.

● WHEN & HOW TO USE IT

Use to open videos that span two contrasting states: before/after, indoor/outdoor, calm/chaotic.

● AI PROMPT

"Whip pan transition from one scene to a visually contrasting scene, motion blur bridging the cut, synced to a sharp sound effect, consistent color grade on both sides."

Fake Notification Hook

Mimic a text or DM notification popping up on screen.

● WHY IT WORKS

Notifications trigger a near-instant checking reflex most people have trained into themselves. The fake version borrows that reflex even though it's not a real notification.

● WHEN & HOW TO USE IT

Use as a story-format opener. Keep the fake UI visually accurate to the real platform, close-but-wrong details break the illusion immediately.

● AI PROMPT

"Screen recording style shot of a phone lock screen, notification banner slides in from the top mimicking a real messaging app, finger reaches to tap it, clean screen glare lighting."

Interactive Hook

Ask the viewer to comment a specific word or number to unlock something.

● WHY IT WORKS

Requesting a small, specific action lowers the barrier to engagement compared to an open-ended 'comment below.' Specific asks get higher completion rates than vague ones.

● WHEN & HOW TO USE IT

Use when you have a real follow-up ready, a resource, a reply video, a DM. Following through builds trust for the next time you use this hook.

● AI PROMPT

"Speaker points directly at camera with an inviting expression, text overlay shows a specific word to comment, bright welcoming lighting, energetic delivery."

KEEP GOING

What's Next

That's 10 of the 100 hooks in the full system. If these earned you a few extra seconds of watch time this week, the rest of the vault is built the same way, organized by category, with the psychology and AI prompts included for every single one.